but found the authorities had not ‘satisfactorily established’ he ‘knew of the militant content of such training.’ It also construed threatening national security to mean promoting or encouraging violence ‘*targeted* at the United Kingdom, its system of government or its people,’ and under such a rubric found that Rehman did not pose such a danger.[160] The SIAC therefore ruled against his deportation. The Home Office won the right to appeal in 2000, a decision which a second appellate court upheld in 2001. In both decisions the appellate courts found that the facts of Rehman’s activities in support of MDI were not in dispute and that the SIAC had interpreted national security too narrowly. The case was remitted to the SIAC to determine on the basis of a broader concept of what constituted a threat to national security; one that took into account the ramifications of supporting a known terrorist organization, albeit an organization not targeting the UK directly.[161] However, after winning the right to reengage deportation proceedings against Rehman, the Home Office dropped the case a year later on the grounds that he had ‘severed links with terrorist organisations’ and thus no longer posed a threat to national security.[162]

When British authorities initially took an interest in Rehman, neither MDI nor Lashkar were illegal entities in the UK. The group was first banned under Britain’s Terrorism Act of 2000, although that legislation was not passed until early 2001. Thereafter, the activities of those associated with MDI and Lashkar in the UK merited more serious scrutiny.[163] The British government banned Lashkar (and MDI) because of the group’s fundraising operations and as a result of the fact that British Pakistanis were training with it. As one member of the British security services explained, by this time the authorities recognized to a greater degree than in the past that, while many British Pakistanis might only have been undergoing short stints with Lashkar, the connections and indoctrination to which they were exposed could have serious consequences.[164] These consequences are illustrated by briefly recounting details of just a few of the Westerners who passed through Lashkar’s camps prior to 9/11.

Dhiren Barot [a.k.a. Abu Eissa al-Hindi], a convert to Islam of Indian origin, grew up in Britain. He trained and fought with Lashkar in Indian-administered Kashmir during the 1990s, and later wrote a book about his experiences.[165] Barot had graduated to al-Qaeda by the end of the decade, making the move primarily because he was enamored with bin Laden’s